

EVERETT HITCH

Ph.D. Student, School of Public Health | University of Nevada, Reno
Graduate Research Assistant, Center for Program Evaluation

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Public Health — Expected August 2029

University of Nevada, Reno, School of Public Health

Graduate Certificate, Social Research Analytics — July 2026

B.S., Psychology — July 2020

University of Utah, Salt Lake City, UT

A.S., General Studies — May 2016

Salt Lake Community College, Salt Lake City, UT

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Social determinants of health; Health policy; Digital systems in healthcare; Community-based physical activity.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant | Center for Program Evaluation (CPE)

University of Nevada, Reno · Aug 2025 – Present

- Lead and support program evaluations for education and public-sector clients, including 21st CCLC youth programs
- Design, distribute, and analyze surveys; conduct data coding, cleaning, and descriptive/inferential analyses
- Co-author technical reports synthesizing findings and recommendations for agency and nonprofit partners
- Conduct Youth Program Quality Assessment (YPQA) observations and scoring with faculty teams

Graduate Research Assistant | Grant Sawyer Center for Justice Studies

University of Nevada, Reno · Aug 2024 – Aug 2025

- Supported multi-sector program evaluations spanning industry, health, and education initiatives
- Contributed to technical report writing, survey operations, coding, and data management

Clinical Research Assistant | CCT Research / IQVIA

Health Information & Technology Research · Feb 2024 – Jul 2024

- Screened, recruited, and enrolled participants in clinical research protocols
- Managed study data, clinical coordination, specimen handling, and protocol documentation

Research Assistant | Utah Cancer Registry

University of Utah Health · May 2023 – Oct 2023

- Conducted patient outreach and collected, entered, and managed clinical registry data

Research Assistant | Applied Cognition Lab — Nature & Cognition

University of Utah, Department of Psychology · Aug 2019 – Dec 2019

- Recruited and scheduled participants; ran experimental procedures; collected and cleaned data

Research Assistant | Applied Cognition Lab — Center for Distracted Driving

University of Utah, Department of Psychology · Jun 2019 – Aug 2019

- Supported experiments on learning and attention with autonomous vehicle systems; data collection and cleaning

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Park, S., Hitch, E., Ryu, S., Friedman, S., Cook, D. M., & Coppes, M. J. (2026). Unequal access and differential use of patient portals: Analysis of HINTS 7 data. Health Communication. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10410236.2026.2711905>

GRANTS & FUNDED PROJECTS

Hillard Endowment Grant (\$1,000) | Social Psychology Club

University of Nevada, Reno · Interdisciplinary Social Psychology Club Chair (Co-author)

- Secured funding for two invited guest speakers

TECHNICAL REPORTS

Giannetta, T., Hitch, E., High, C., Saunders, S., & Christiansen, E. (2026, July 1). Larry D. Johnson Community Center 21st Century Community Learning Centers Youth Program Quality Assessment (YPQA) Report 2025-2026. University of Nevada, Reno, Center for Program Evaluation.

Lee, C., Hitch, E., Saunders, S., & Christiansen, E. (2026, June 22). Donald L. Carano 21st Century Community Learning Centers Program Quality Assessment (PQA) Report 2025-2026. University of Nevada, Reno, Center for Program Evaluation.

Christiansen, E. J., Saunders, S., Hitch, E., Juniel, P. M., Giannetta, T., High, C., & Dahir, V. B. (2026, April 30). Nevada Department of Education McKinney-Vento Program Landscape Analysis & Evaluation Report. University of Nevada, Reno.

Saunders, S., Hitch, E., Giannetta, T., Dahir, V. B., & Christiansen, E. (2026). Nevada Department of Transportation (NDOT) 2026 Employee Satisfaction Survey. University of Nevada, Reno, Center for Surveys, Evaluation, and Statistics.

Saunders, S., Karandikar, S., Giannetta, T., Hitch, E., Lee, C., Christiansen, E., & Dahir, V. B. (2025, September 30). Boys & Girls Club of Truckee Meadows 21st Century Community Learning Centers: Cohort 7 Evaluation Report 2024-2025. University of Nevada, Reno.

Hitch, E., Saunders, S., Christiansen, E., & Dahir, V. B. (2025, April 25). Larry D. Johnson Community Center 21st Century Community Learning Centers Youth Program Quality Assessment (YPQA) Report 2024-2025. University of Nevada, Reno, Center for Surveys, Evaluation, and Statistics.

Lee, C., Owusu Sekyere, R., Hitch, E., Saunders, S., Christiansen, E., & Dahir, V. B. (2025, April 24). Donald L. Carano 21st Century Community Learning Centers Program Quality Assessment (PQA) Report 2024-2025. University of Nevada, Reno, Center for Surveys, Evaluation, and Statistics.

Hitch, E., Giannetta, T., Saunders, S., Christiansen, E., & Dahir, V. B. (2025, April 24). Dilworth Middle School 21st Century Community Learning Centers Youth Program Quality Assessment (YPQA) Report 2024-2025. University of Nevada, Reno, Center for Surveys, Evaluation, and Statistics.

Hart, D. J., Hitch, E., Lee, B. M., & Dahir, V. B. (2024, October 2). Nevada Department of Transportation (NDOT) 2024 Employee Satisfaction Survey. University of Nevada, Reno, Center for Surveys, Evaluation, and Statistics.

Saunders, S., Karandikar, S., Giannetta, T., Cerfoglio, A., Garcia Aguilar, C., Lee, C., Hitch, E., Christiansen, E., & Dahir, V. B. (2024, September 30). Boys & Girls Club of Truckee Meadows 21st Century Community Learning Centers: Cohort 7 Evaluation Report 2023-2024. University of Nevada, Reno.

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Wilderness Therapy Guide | Aspiro Wilderness Therapy

Psychology Internship · Mar 2020 – Mar 2021

- Designed and led therapeutic wilderness itineraries (backpacking, climbing, skiing) in collaboration with clinical teams
- Facilitated group and recreational therapy sessions supporting adolescent behavioral health goals

Health Unit Coordinator | Huntsman Mental Health Institute, University of Utah

Mar 2019 – Mar 2020

- Coordinated communications among patients, treatment teams, administration, and emergency services
- Managed scheduling, admissions/discharges, and clinical supply inventory

Psychiatric Technician | Huntsman Mental Health Institute, University of Utah

Mar 2017 – Mar 2019

- Supported patient assessment and treatment interventions; facilitated group therapy and behavioral supports

- Collected behavioral and vital-sign data; assisted with medication administration, blood draws, and ECGs

Resort Agent | Lodge at Snowbird

Aug 2021 – Nov 2023

- Managed lodging sales and owner accounts in a high-volume resort operations setting

SKILLS

Methods: Program evaluation; survey design & operations; Youth Program Quality Assessment (YPQA/PQA); qualitative thematic analysis; clinical research coordination

Data & tools: Data coding/cleaning; descriptive analysis; Qualtrics; technical report writing; literature review

Applied: Participant recruitment; stakeholder communication; youth & community programming

CERTIFICATIONS

CITI Program — Social/Behavioral Researchers and Key Personnel · Feb 2025

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American College of Sports Medicine (ACSM) — Student Member · Aug 2025 – Present

Nature Human Health Utah (NHH-UT), University of Utah · Aug 2022 – Present

SELECTED VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Equine Therapy Research Volunteer | Horsemanship for Heroes

May 2026 – Jun 2026

- Conducted preliminary interviews and supported data collection and coding for equine therapy research

Youth Climbing Coach | Momentum Climbing Gym

Nov 2022 – Jan 2024

- Coached climbing programs for ages 6–18 and facilitated youth competitions

Outdoor Recreation Volunteer | Elevated Mountain Guides

Jul 2022 – Dec 2023

- Supported community outreach program development, facilitation, and outdoor education

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Wilderness Medicine in the Alps (Chamonix) — University of Utah School of Medicine, Jun 2019

Psychology Internship — Huntsman Mental Health Institute (S. McLaughlin, Ph.D.), Jan–Mar 2020

Psychology Internship — Aspiro Wilderness Therapy (G. Larson, LCSW), Mar–May 2020